

UNDERSTANDING MARGINALISATION

Q1. Write in your own words two or more sentences of what you understand by the word ‘marginalisation’.

Ans. Marginalization means when a certain person or a group of people are made to feel of lesser importance, by those in power. Marginalised groups are viewed with hostility and fear.

Q2. List two reasons why Adivasis are becoming increasingly marginalised.

Ans. Adivasis are becoming increasingly marginalised for various reasons. Among these, two important reasons are:

a) We know Adivasis are deeply rooted with forests. Forest policies of the Government and change in the forest laws have deprived them the access to forests and forest products. So they lost their main source of livelihood.

b) Clearing of forest land for timber, construction of factories and other projects in tribal areas have forced Adivasis to migrate to towns and cities in search of work.

Q3. Write one reason why you think the Constitution safeguards to protect minority communities are very important?

Ans. We know that minorities are marginalised sections of the society which are deprived of many opportunities of socio-economic development. They are deprived of many rights and are forced to live on fringes (borders) rather than in the mainstream. So constitutional safeguards are necessary to protect the minority communities against the exploitation by majority community on the basis of religion, caste etc.

Q4. Re-read the sections on Minorities and Marginalisation. What do you understand by the term minority?

Ans. A minority is a community which is numerically small in relation with the rest of the population. Also, a particular religious section of society which has a low percentage in population as compared to the major religious community is called a minority. For example, Muslims are 14.2% of India's population. So in India, Muslims are a minority.

Q5. You are participating in a debate where you have to provide reasons to support the following statement: 'Muslims are a marginalized community'. Using the data provided in this chapter, list two reasons that you would give.

Ans. The two reasons are:-

1. Muslims are deprived of basic amenities such as tap water, pucca house and electricity.
2. They have little access to education.

Q6. Imagine that you are watching the republic day parade on T.V with a friend and she remarks, "look at these tribals. They look so exotic. And they seem to be dancing all the time." List three things that you would tell her about the lives of adivasis in India.

Ans. The three things that I learnt about the lives of adivasis in India are:-

1. They are original inhabitants who lived and often continue to live in close association with forests.
2. They have great knowledge about plants and their uses.
3. They have their own languages which have often deeply influenced the formation of mainstream Indian languages like Bengali.

Q7. Self-Attempt

Q8. Would you agree with the statement that economic marginalisation and social marginalisation are interlinked? Why?

Ans. Yes I agree that economic marginalisation and social marginalisation are interlinked. When Adivasis are forced to leave their native land on the pretext of forest laws and development, they are deprived of their social and cultural identity on one hand and on the other hand, they lose their source of income i.e. forest and forest products. They are forced to migrate to towns and cities in search of work to earn their livelihood. Social marginalisation forces a social group like a minority out of the mainstream, resulting in the lack of opportunities for education and development. As a result, they lack financial development and hence are economically marginalised.